6.4 Exponential Functions

Name _____ Period ____ Date _____

Algebra I 6.4 · Student sheet

I can…

- identify and evaluate exponential functions.
- graph exponential functions and find their asymptote, domain, and range.
- tell whether a table or situation is linear or exponential.

Part 1 · Savings plans

Plan A: save $10 on day 1, $20 on day 2, $30 on day 3, and so on. Plan B: save $1 on day 1, $2 on day 2, $4 on day 3, doubling each day.

Day	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Plan A ($)	10	20	30							
Plan B ($)	1	2	4							

Plan A: each day I _____. Plan B: each day I _____.

Which plan saves more on day 10? Which would you choose for 4 days?

Part 2 · Notes: fill in the blanks

An **exponential function** has the form y = _____, where a ≠ 0, b > 0, and b ≠ 1.

Linear tables have a constant _____. Exponential tables have a constant _____.

The graph of $y = ab^x + k$ has an asymptote at _____. The domain is _____.

A situation is exponential when it changes by the same _____ each time.

Part 3 · Examples (work them with the class)

Example 1

Does each equation represent an exponential function?

a. $y = 4(7)^x$ b. $y = -6x$ c. $y = x^3$

Example 2

Is each table linear or exponential?

a. x: 0, 1, 2, 3 y: 3, 6, 12, 24

b. x: 0, 1, 2, 3 y: 1, 4, 7, 10

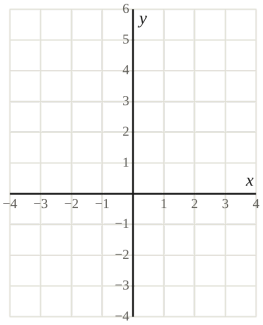
Example 3

Evaluate each function.

a. $y = -2(5)^x$ when $x = 3$ b. $y = 3(\frac{1}{2})^x$ when $x = -2$

Example 4

Graph $y = 2^x$ and $y = 2^x - 3$. Find the y-intercept, asymptote, domain, and range of $y = 2^x - 3$.



Example 5

Is each situation linear or exponential?

a. A tank loses 7 gallons of water every hour.

b. A town’s population grows 3% every year.

Part 4 · Partner practice

Partner 1

Evaluate $y = 4(3)^x$ when $x = 2$.

Partner 2

For $y = 3^x + 2$, find the y-intercept, asymptote, and range.